Where Are You? Start Here

A diagnostic flowchart for choosing your ocean account

◆ Your Policy Question

"How much ecosystem do we have?"

□

EXTENT ACCOUNT

Map area (ha) of each ecosystem type. Track gains and losses over time.

"How healthy is our ecosystem?"

★

CONDITION ACCOUNT

Measure key indicators against a reference benchmark. Score 0 to 1.

"What benefits do people get?"

♦

SERVICES ACCOUNT

Quantify flows of goods and services from ecosystems to people, in physical and monetary terms.

⚙ What data do you have?

□

Pathway A

No primary data

Use global open datasets and literature values. A valid Tier 1 account.

☑

Mix A + B

Some data available

Combine global datasets with national statistics and local reports.

☒

Pathway B

Field data exists

Primary surveys, monitoring programs, or high-resolution imagery available.

Beyond SEEA-EA: The Complete Ocean Accounting Framework

Ocean accounts extend well beyond ecosystem extent, condition, and services

⚖ Ocean Economy Satellite Account (OESA)

How big is the ocean economy? Reorganize national accounts to measure ocean GDP.

When: You want to measure fisheries, shipping, tourism, mining contribution to GDP

☼ Ocean Tourism Satellite Account (OTSA)

What does coastal tourism contribute? A focused satellite account for ocean-dependent tourism.

When: Tourism is a major sector and you need economic data

☢ Waste & Emissions (SEEA-CF)

What pollution enters the ocean? Track water emissions, solid waste, and air emissions from ocean industries.

When: You want to measure pollution, plastics, or shipping emissions

♥ Social & Governance (GOAP)

Who benefits? Who is affected? Compile data on wellbeing, livelihoods, equity, culture.

When: You want to understand the human dimension of ocean management

Ocean accounts are not just environmental. The full framework covers environment (SEEA-EA), economy (OESA), pollution (SEEA-CF), and society (GOAP).